

Joshua Book

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Arbor Energy · El Segundo, CA

Re: Sr. Business Systems Manager (Data and Automation)

Dear Arbor Energy team,

I was researching waste biomass pathways for a project I'd been working on — using spent seaweed from dashi production for biochar and energy recovery — when I came across Arbor Energy. A system that takes bio-waste and converts it into water, heat, and electricity. Founded by ex-SpaceX engineers. Rocket technology running in reverse. Just wow. And here in Los Angeles. It felt like a bit of destiny, honestly, and my draw to Arbor has remained really strong ever since.

I'm writing because the Sr. Business Systems Manager role sits at an intersection I've spent the last twelve years inhabiting: making the internal systems of growing organizations actually work. Connecting data, people, processes, and tools into something coherent — especially when the starting point is ambiguity and the stakes are real.

At the NYC Campaign Finance Board, I led a business systems and process transformation — designing governance frameworks, OKRs, and metrics infrastructure from scratch, translating policy constraints and stakeholder needs into technical roadmaps. When a major campaign cycle created a data surge, I redesigned workflows and data processing pipelines to handle the volume with real resiliency. That work is the shape of what I think you need: someone who can look at a messy operational landscape, figure out what connects to what, and build the systems that make it coherent and scalable.

At Cerca, I was the first technical hire for a multi-actor service platform. I designed the information architecture — a human-in-the-loop routing and matching system with structured alerting, handoff workflows, and data capture. I built API-driven backend systems, real-time event-driven workflows, and integration layers connecting communication services to operational coordination. Basically: I built the connective tissue of a complex operational system from the ground up.

Earlier at Def Method, I contributed to ETL pipelines at JOOR for ingesting and structuring large volumes of client data, led a five-engineer squad at Walmart Labs building a greenfield logistics coordination system, and managed engineering teams with a focus on sustainable delivery. The common thread: cross-functional systems work where the value comes from connecting domains.

I want to be direct about the climate piece because it's not decorative. I completed the Climatebase Fellowship this year with Innovator Distinction. My capstone project, Brine & Ember, explored exactly the kind of circular thinking Arbor embodies — seaweed-based bioenergy and biochar production, integrating carbon sequestration with food-system circularity. I've since been building BELT, climate software for evaluating biochar and carbon removal venture viability. I'm deeply drawn to using the power of plants — assisted with the best technical ingenuity — to solve some of the most core problems we face as a planetary society.

What I want to do at Arbor is what I do best: work on complex problems, surface latent value, connect people and processes and teams, and serve as an irreplaceable glue and catalyst of momentum. You're building something extraordinary. The internal systems that support that work need to be just as thoughtfully designed. I'd love the chance to build them with you.

Warmly,

Joshua Book